applicable, given India is a highly stratified society. But by and large, an aggressively aspirational India doesn't see the government as their 'mai-baap' and certainly doesn't feel beholden to the support that has brought them so far in the past seventy years. This is not to suggest that people don't need an enabling civic and political infrastructure to enable them to achieve their functionings. They do. And it is the government's moral duty to do whatever it takes to ensure their needs and aspirations are met. But people don't want that support to be characterized as dole. Yearning for samman (respect and dignity), samruddhi (progress and prosperity) and, most of all, vikaas (development),[10] many Indians are progressively anxious about their place in society and are displaying a 'mixture of *rebellious* emotions and *reactionary* social ideas'.[11] They feel angry at being *left out* (because of seemingly inadequate prospects of socio-economic advancement) and angrier at being *held back* (because of nepotism, corruption and a perceived sense of unfair State patronage towards minorities and historically marginalized communities). This heady mixture of confusing emotions is being exacerbated by the phenomenon of urban loneliness,[12] and is being projected on the internet. One of the consequent by-products of this phenomenon is a strong belief that the establishment, civil society organizations, the intelligentsia and sections of the media are delaying the restoration of Bharat (India) to its past glory; and that liberal, secular and democratic values are a threat to Indian (and more specifically Hindu) sanskar (culture). The influence of this mass psychosis cannot be underestimated, since it has paved the way for a frontal attack on the constitutional idea of India.

For example, three disparate groups in Maharashtra posed dramatically contrarian views. On the one hand, some eminent Dalit thinkers and activists were determined to ask Rahul Gandhi about the Congress party's stance on reservations for the Economically Weaker Section. They felt that it undermined India's constitutional framework. On the other hand, a delegation of senior Maratha community leaders wanted to demand reservations for Marathas (that they felt could be actualized by carving it out from quotas reserved for Socially and Educationally Backward Classes,